

Nilson Gaspar

Senior Product Designer | developer tools, observability and data platforms

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SUMMARY

Fourteen years designing, last eight focused on technical products for the people who build software. I work on mental models, information architecture, user feedback and the shared language a team needs before any pixel, down to code prototyping.

At Grafana and Dynatrace I led design on platform scale problems, co-owned multi year product vision, led across squads and mentored designers at senior/principal scope.

Designed Grafana's APM and Frontend Observability products from scratch as the only designer on the team, launched head to head with Datadog and New Relic.

Designed Spaces, the governance layer that lets Dynatrace's largest enterprise customers share one environment across many teams safely, taking it from an open mandate to a committed MVP scope and two year vision.

SKILLS

Design: information architecture, interaction design, design systems, user research, high fidelity prototyping

Tools and code: Figma, HTML/CSS, AI-augmented prototyping

Domains: observability, developer tooling, data platforms, AIOps

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Designer, Dynatrace Oct 2025 – Apr 2026

The observability and AIOps platform used by 3,500+ enterprise customers | Role eliminated in a company wide restructuring

- **Spaces (platform governance).** Took Spaces from an open ended governance mandate to a committed MVP scope and a two year UX vision. Authored the “geography” mental model that became PM, Engineering and UX’s shared language for the problem. Environment = planet, Space = country (the governance boundary), Segment = Zip code (the data filter). Steered the pivot from a three version selector model to a simpler “V4, invisible by default” approach without reopening a single decision: all 38 documented edge cases and the signal routing decision tree survived the pivot intact. Surfaced 8 critical access control problems early enough to shape MVP scope by auditing the identity and access flow across all 70+ platform apps. Designed and coded the prototype the team adopted as its primary design medium.
- **Settings Platform redesign.** Turned a fragmented configuration surface (no landing page, mixed organisational paradigms, inheritance behaviour nobody could discover) into one coherent system: a single information architecture, one unified search replacing three separate search/filter systems, and the platform’s first documented settings inheritance rules. Grounded the IA in benchmarks of GitHub, Stripe, Salesforce, Datadog, Grafana and AWS, and designed a mega menu navigation that gave sidebar space back to the content. Built the working prototype in React.

- **Team.** Mentored 2 senior designers and 1 principal designer; introduced AI augmented prototyping and problem first practices; turned a strained relationship between PM and UX into a working partnership.

Designer and Developer (independent), Keystrok Jul 2024 – Present

Open source, self hosted secrets hygiene tool | keystrok.dev | [GitHub.com/Rootzreggae/keystrok](https://github.com/Rootzreggae/keystrok)

- Designed and built the product solo, and it's live: Keystrok finds exposed API keys in a codebase, tracks each one in a severity ranked ledger, and walks engineers through safe rotation. Advisory by designer, never automates the irreversible step. Shaped the product's judgement calls (liveness aware urgency, operator gated revocation, an AI assistant that reasons over key metadata but never sees secrets) and validated them with working DevOps engineers. Product stack: Next.js, React, TypeScript, Prisma/PostgreSQL. Built with AI as my engineering partner, every design, ideation, research and architecture judgement call are mine.

Senior Product Designer, Grafana Labs May 2022 – Jul 2024

One of the most widely used open source observability platforms

- **Application Observability (APM).** Opened the product to teams outside DevOps: user interviews showed non technical users abandoning a cluttered product within their first week, so I redesigned it around progressive disclosure, visual discovery, and goal oriented information architecture.
- **Frontend Observability (RUM).** Took a greenfield product to launch head to head with Datadog and New Relic. Went hands on with OpenTelemetry and the Faro web SDK to design with the grain of the data, using high fidelity prototypes rather than static mockups to carry the team through every major iteration.
- **Design system.** Contributed patterns adopted across the company
- **Onboarding.** Three years on, the onboarding Grafana ships today. is still built on the user flows, design system contributions and visual language I originated.

Senior Product Designer, KI Challengers Aug 2020 – May 2022

Digital innovation consultancy serving Fortune 500 clients

- Led design on data driven products across multiple client launches, aligning UX with each client's growth goals.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Lead Product Designer, Jungle (Sep 2019 – Aug 2020). Designed Jungle.AI end to end and built the product's first real application underlying data model and UI, replacing a CLI and PDF report based workflow.

UX lead, Comparamais (2018 - 2 Sep 2019). End to end ownership of a Portuguese price comparison platform, from product strategy to shipped features.

UX/UI Designer, Aptoide (Jan 2016 – Dec 2017). Store UX and in app reviews flows for the Android app store, plus illustration, branding, and event collateral.